Y2021 PROMOTION EXAMINATION FOR AGMs & DGMs

TEST TYPE: PLANNING, STRATEGY AND LEADERSHIP
SITUATIONAL JUDGEMENT TEST

In this test you will be asked to imagine yourself in a number of different scenarios and roles. You will be presented with situations and asked to select the response you believe you would be 'most' and 'least' likely to make to these situations from a range of options. It is recommended you read all the possible responses before deciding how to respond.

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS
DURATION: 1 HOUR

Points:

1. What is your full name *

Scenario 1

Funsho & Cara are a reputable department-based retailer and have been established in Lagos for over one hundred years. They specialise in a range of products including clothing, furniture, homewares, groceries, spa products, beauty and footwear. Despite the continuing success of their "lifestyle" stores, Funsho & Cara are eager to implement innovative methods to attract new customers, while continuing to satisfy returning shoppers, as a means to fend-off competition from rival brands and maintain their footing in the marketplace.

To achieve the company's latest objectives, they have hired you as a business strategy consultant. This role requires you to assess the current processes used by Funsho & Cara and formulate

procedures to improve the internal and external structure of the business, while introducing creative ideas to achieve the company's goals.

2. In order to increase the number of consumers who complete a transaction in store, as opposed to just browsing, it has been suggested that Funsho & Cara reduce their prices to encourage a new range of customers. However, the pricing and sales department have said that the expensive prices are part of the exclusivity of the brand, giving it a luxury feel and reputation for excellence. It is true that the company name is associated with quality and exclusivity, however, the intent to attract a new clientele is necessary for the company to remain relevant within its niche.

Review the following responses and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. In a tactical effort to protect the brand, advise that Funsho & Cara continue with the

O current pricing scheme; by reducing the price of the products, you could reduce the value of the company itself.

B. Propose that Funsho & Cara wait to see if rival companies begin to win customers

O from them, in order to avoid making a hasty decision that could change the reputation of their brand.

C. Suggest that the prices should be reduced for a limited period of time, as this will give the brand an affordable reputation and should help to encourage new customers.

D. Introduce a new, more expensive range within the stores, while simultaneously reducing the prices of the existing goods. This should make the brand more affordable, while still providing a luxury line of products for those who wish to opt for exclusive items.

It has been brought to your attention that Funsho & Cara customers are increasingly favouring a company called Montpellier. Montpellier specialise in

3.

authentic French baked goods, ranging from traditional baguettes to patisserie treats, and have received praise for their original techniques and recipes inspired by European flavours. The news of Montpellier's rising popularity is a concern, as Funsho & Cara have recently experienced a decline in the sales regarding their own bakery and in-house tea room, a staple that would ordinarily yield significant profit for the company.

Review the following responses and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Suggest that Funsho & Cara develop their own selection of luxury European pastries,

O in an attempt to compete with Montpellier and increase the revenue generated by their in house tea room.

B. Encourage Funsho & Cara to try and replicate the goods sold by Montpellier, as they O are already an established brand and could detract from the attention garnered by Montpellier.

O C. Advise that the company abandon their in-house tea room and opt to provide a new service in store that would not be threatened by Montpellier's future success.

D. Propose that Funsho & Cara form a reseller partnership with Montpellier, allowing them to sell Montpellier produce in their in-house tea room.

4. Following the recent acquisition of Montpellier, an authentic French patisserie company, Funsho & Cara are hoping to replace the products that are currently being sold at their in- house tea room with those of this new business. However, in order to uphold the current standard of Montpellier produce, a complete renovation of the present in-house tea room will be required throughout stores. Although financial analysis of this development suggests it would be beneficial to the company long-term, liquid assets could be vital to its initial success, meaning that company cost-cutting may be needed.

Review the following responses and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

O A. Carry out the renovation whilst keeping costs to a minimum, allowing Funsho & Cara to avoid staff downsizing or damaging cuts to day-to-day operations.

B. Perform an assessment of Funsho & Cara's departments in order to analyse the most
O suitable area for structural realignment, allowing for the removal of any inefficient or ✓redundant aspects of the business.

C. Introduce the new products within the existing in-house tea room, to avoid renovation costs and further expenditure.

O D. Propose that Funsho & Cara re-assess the wages of the present staff in the department, in an attempt to create some financial flexibility during the renovation.

A recent survey regarding the attitudes among the general public towards different high street retailers yielded feedback that was primarily positive for Funsho & Cara, with many customers praising the quality of their products. Although it appears as though the company could benefit from incorporating stronger interaction with its clientele, in order to uphold a "caring and approachable" standing among the public. With many companies already adopting the use of social media, Funsho & Cara are reluctant to do the same, at the risk of overwhelming customers with streams of information and would prefer to employ a different approach to achieving their goal.

Review the following responses and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

O A. Reassure the company that social media is an important tool in the promotion of today's businesses and suggest that they reconsider their dismissal of its use.

B. Suggest that the customer feedback section of the company website should be

5.

O redesigned so that it is more engaging, increasing the likelihood that those browsing ✓the site will provide opinions of their shopping experience.

O C. Reiterate the fact that Funsho & Cara received "primarily positive" feedback regarding the public survey, recommending that no further action is necessary.

D. Propose that Funsho & Cara encourage customer interaction in-store, for example by

O continuing the items that receive the greatest public demand or by listening to feedback in-store.

Scenario 2

You are a Project Manager working for Futureforce Energy plc, a niche provider of energy and energy technology to the Borno domestic and commercial market. Futureforce generates and distributes energy only from renewable sources; its portfolio currently includes:

I.production of solar and photovoltaic panels II. installation and management of solar and photovoltaic panels III. production of energy from wind farms and off-shore windfarms

IV. production and distribution of 'eco-gas' produced by anaerobic digestion of household food waste

Futureforce is always looking for new energy sources and products to add to its portfolio and you are based in the Department for Research and Development which drives this search.
You lead a project team of 7 researchers and administrators who have a wide remit "to investigate and evaluate new sources of renewable energy and supporting technologies".

6. Your team have been tasked with an urgent project to evaluate a new method to harness wind power using trees. The trees are fitted with technology that harvests the energy from the movement of the leaves and branches when the wind hits the tree. This energy can then be stored and converted into electricity and used as normal.

Your team's remit is to produce a report on the viability, cost and potential of this technology for use in the Nigerian energy market. One of the prototype treemotion harnessing kits has been delivered to the team this morning; your line manager, the Head of R&D, has asked that a report be forthcoming from the team by this Friday which is 3 days from now. The urgency is because there is

competition from other providers to purchase this technology from the Swedish inventor responsible.
You have just been briefing the team on this task to which they have reacted rather negatively. John Sunomi, the most senior research officer in the team, summed their views up by saying "whatever we manage to investigate and report in this amount of time will be flawed at best and completely erroneous at worst". You have concluded that the team view the project deadlines as unrealistic.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the most effective response.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

O A. Tell the team that they have no choice but to do their best to deliver something meaningful in the time available.

O B. Ask your team what they can realistically do in the time available and offer this as a compromise to the Head of R&D.

O C. Immediately go back to the Head of R&D and communicate your team's views; ask for an extension on the deadline. ✓

O D. Tell your team to work through the weekend; this will add an extra two days to the project time available.

One of the ongoing roles of your team has been to monitor the utility and effectiveness of the use of solar and photovoltaic panels in various locations. The data is analysed to produce a quarterly report on the optimal positioning, angling and geographical location of such panels. The data is gathered from the panels that Futureforce installs and manages for domestic and business customers and the reports need to be continually updated as more and more panels are installed. However, the government this morning announced that they would no longer be subsidising the sell-back of micro-produced electricity to the national grid. Energy experts quickly interpreted the consequences of this announcement as being a sharp fall in demand for domestic solar and photovoltaic panels. This is because panel owners will now only receive a fraction of the income that they did previously from selling their home-produced power to the national grid. It

7.

will mean that it will take much longer to make back the investment in a solar panel from now on.
You have just had a call from the Head of R&D who has told you that the implications for Futureforce could be serious and that the head count of your team may be threatened. You may have to lose 2 of your team of 7 as the analytical work regarding the solar panel data will no longer be required.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the most effective response.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

O A. Draw up a list of the team members who you think should be made redundant, if it were to come to that.

O B. Send an email to all your staff outlining the implications of the government announcement for Futureforce.

C. Call a brief team meeting and ensure that the staff is aware of the government o announcement and the overall implications for Futureforce. Answer any immediate questions honestly and openly.

D. Do nothing for now, as the redundancy threat is only a possibility and you don't want to worry your staff.

8.

Today you have had a call from a Futureforce Customer Service Officer, Anna Zovari. Anna told you that the customer service team had had an influx of calls over the last few days from recipients of the latest photovoltaic panels to have been installed by Futureforce. The customer service team have received 20 calls from this group over the last week and all the callers reported that the panels were generating little or no electricity.
Anna noticed that this was a pattern and immediately contacted the installation team to see if there had been any recent issues which might explain the problems. The installers insist that they had not varied their routine and therefore Anna contacted you to find out what the possible causes of the problems could be in order to relay this to customers. You thanked her for her call and told her that you would get back to her shortly.
Your initial thoughts on this are firstly that the production department are probably responsible and that this is a faulty batch of panels and secondly, that your team are very busy with strategic research work and really haven't got time to investigate manufacturing problems.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the most effective response.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

O A. Call Anna back and say that she should contact the production department as it is their responsibility.

O B. Ask one of your team to talk to Anna and give her a brief run-down of the various possibilities that could have caused the problem.

C. Call the Head of Production & Manufacturing and alert him to the problem; tell Anna

O what you have done and that she should contact him but say she is welcome to talk any ✓ issues through with one of your team as well if she would like.

O D. Call your line manager and ask that customer services issues aren't referred to your team in future as it is not your responsibility.

9.

Your team are currently investigating approximately eight different new sustainable energy sources and technologies. These projects are all at different stages of research, some being closer to a firm conclusion than others. You attended an R&D Department meeting yesterday where departmental strategy was discussed. The Group Commercial Director (GCD) attended the meeting as a special guest and told you all that Futureforce needs research results which translate more speedily into commercial products. You therefore agreed with the GCD and the Head of R&D that a new approach was needed for the coming year and that the team's resources should be concentrated on the two most realistic and immediately realisable technologies or sources. The other six more speculative and unlikely projects would need to be put on the backburner for now.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the most effective response.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

O A. Decide which two projects are to continue based on which contain the most 'recognisable' technologies from your point-of-view.

O B. Ask each team member to email you with information on their own project and with arguments as to why their project should be saved, given the GCD's criteria.

C. Ask your team to get together and rank order the projects based on their best guess as to the 'likely commercial viability' of the technologies involved.

O D. Decide which two projects are to continue based on which are closest to reporting their final conclusions.

Scenario 3

You are a Project Manager working for an IT consultancy named Cloud Space.
The company has 24 employees and a team of three Directors. The work is structured on a project basis, in this way a team is formed to work on a project for a client and a project

manager (PM) is assigned to the team. The PM is responsible for the work of the team and for the welfare and development of the team members whilst the project is running.

Cloud Space currently has 4 Senior Project Managers and 2 Assistant PMS who will run the smaller projects. You are a Senior Project Manager.
Cloud Space is a web-specialist IT consultancy and works with business clients to design, build and maintain public websites, internal company websites and to develop e-marketing & e-commerce systems.

10. You are running a Project with a business client called Carl Brown. They are an upmarket toiletries company who have traditionally supplied quality high street retailers, hotels and private health clubs with their products for purchase and use by consumers. They are opening a number of direct retail outlets in the near future and have asked Cloud Space to design a website to publicise this development and to raise awareness of Carl Brown products to more 'mainstream' consumers. You have a team of 3 web developers and you and your team have been working closely with the PR and marketing team from Carl Brown to design and build the website. The project was due to run for 13 weeks; you are now at the end of the 8th week of the project.
You have just had a call from your key contact in the Carl Brown, the Director of Marketing, Sam Adeyemi. He says that the retail strategy has changed over the last few weeks and that Carl Brown now want the website to have 'e-commerce' capability; they want customers to be able to order and pay for products on the website and arrange for home delivery. Sam would like a meeting with you later today and wants to understand from you, the implications of the new project brief.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Ask Sam if you can have a little more time to consider this issue as you need to consult with your colleagues, and with your team of Directors at Cloud Space, before you are able to commit to new project requirements. Ask if you could meet up in one or two days' time instead.

B. Ask the Cloud Space e-commerce specialist and one of the team of Directors to

O accompany you to the meeting this afternoon in order that all the issues and considerations are addressed properly.

11.

C. Contact your team of Directors and ask that one of them attends the meeting instead

O of you — you feel that a change of project requirement needs a higher level 'sign-off' than you are able to provide.

D. Consult the Cloud Space e-commerce specialist, by email or phone, and also talk the issues through with the project team. Work up an outline document including new

O realistic project deadlines, issues that may arise and new costs for the project. Send a ✓ copy of the document to your Directorial team, explaining the situation, and use it as a basis for a discussion with Sam this afternoon.

12. have

You now agreed the e-commerce project changes with Sam of Carl Brown and with your Directorial team. The changes have meant that the project has been extended by 5 weeks and it has pushed Carl Brown to the limits of their budget for the website development and therefore they are very keen that the work is delivered on time and within budget.
You are now 4 weeks from completion and the project is running on time. However there have been some delays on one element of the work and you have had to spend some time helping out with the team member responsible whose name is Lisa Weldon. Lisa's part of the project is ensuring the security and safety of the e-commerce payment methods and ensuring compatibility of the Carl Brown website with the Nigerian banks' web-based systems. You are worried because over the next few weeks you don't have as much time available to chip in with Lisa's work and she may fall behind again.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Have a chat with Lisa and say that you are confident that she will be able to complete

O the rest of the work with less input from you. Boost her self-esteem by praising the work that she has done so far.

B. Have a detailed discussion with Lisa about her part of the project; ask her about her confidence with the brief. Find out the cause of Lisa's problems (e.g. is the 'e-

O commerce' area a new one for her and does she need some expert coaching or training ✓to build her knowledge?). Depending on the outcome of your discussion, ask colleagues to give her help and support as appropriate.

O C. Leave Lisa with a detailed written note of your expectations of her part of the project. Check in with her at the end of each day or two, to ensure that she is 'on track'.

D. Ask the Cloud Space e-commerce expert to run a session with Lisa giving her some

O one-to-one coaching on the software challenges involved in web-based payment systems.

13. have

You recently been assigned to a new project following the departure of one of the Cloud Space Senior Project Managers. You have taken over the project about one-third of the way into the work.

The client for the project is Abuja Municipal Council and your key contact there is Benjamin Guyak, IT Services Manager. The work is a re-design of the Council website to make the site more interactive so that council taxpayers can search for events, information and local news from an online database.

You have just finished a phone call with Benjamin Guyak and he has raised some issues with you about the way that Cloud Space have been working. He commented that the previous PM appeared to be unenthusiastic about the project and that some of your project staff were rather lacking in energy and commitment; they appeared to feel that 'local authority' work was 'beneath them'. He said that two of his IT Services staff told him about a meeting with a Cloud Space consultant who had told them to leave the 'difficult bits to him' as he imagined that they "wouldn't have been exposed to much cutting-edge technology working for the council".

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Call a team meeting to get to the bottom of what has been going on and remind

O them of their responsibility to be committed to the project and responsive & polite to the clients at all times.

B. Talk to each of your team members individually and find out their perspective on the client relationship. Advise them all that they should always be responsive and respectful

O to clients. Speak to Benjamin tell him of the process you have been through, apologise ✓ for the past misunderstandings and assure him of Cloud Space's commitment to this work.

C. Call a team meeting and state that rude behaviour towards a client is unacceptable

O and that anyone found to have been less than respectful to Benjamin and his team will be taken off the project and reported to the Cloud Space Directors.

D. Don't worry too much about Benjamin's comments. The previous PM has gone which

14. have

O solves one issue, also you are sure that under your leadership the team will work effectively and deliver a great product for Benjamin which will leave him very satisfied.

Cloud Space a long-standing client called Picky which is an online retailer selling household goods, cleaning products, clothes, kitchenware and DIY products. You are the lead manager for the Picky account although currently there is little development work being done for the client. Their website is operational and uses an automated content management system so that Picky staff can easily make changes to the products and prices on the site without help from Cloud Space consultants.
You have just received an email from a colleague telling you that the rolling news channels are reporting a takeover of Picky's by the US firm Waldart Inc. Your colleague says that the takeover is being referred to as 'confirmed' and due to be finalised in the next few weeks.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which you believe to be the 'most effective' response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

O A. Ask your colleague what they think about the situation and what the implications are for Cloud Space and Picky working together.

O B. Call your key contact at Picky and ask for a quick update on how things are going and whether there is anything new that Cloud Space can help with.

O C. Do nothing and wait to see how the situation unfolds over the next couple of weeks.

D. Research on the internet and in the financial pages of broadsheet newspapers to check what the likely situation is with the takeover. Draw up some projections of potential work that Cloud Space could offer to Picky / Waldart, such as re-branding of the website.

15. have

Scenario 4

You are the manager of a team of financial advisors who provide a service to the high net- worth private clients of Zenith Bank Plc.
You have a team of 10 advisors and you are responsible for managing the team, supporting them in achieving their revenue targets and dealing with any client feedback.

Your advisors are specialists in high-value investments and are well-trained in their area of expertise. They have to work within strict guidelines with regard to the advice that they can give to clients (for example, they must always be able to demonstrate that they have clearly explained the risks involved

in any investment to their clients).
The advisors have targets for earning commission and other income for Zenith Bank which are reviewed quarterly.

14. Your team have been meeting their targets very well so far this year. It is currently late November, just coming up to the end of the third quarter and the team are on track to meet or exceed all their revenue targets.

You have just had an email from your line manager (the Head of Private Banking) who has congratulated you and your team on their performance. He has also said that because of the success of the team he is increasing their final quarter targets by 20%. In addition, he is keen to see the target for investment by clients in offshore bonds being exceeded in the final quarter as they are 'selling like hotcakes' at the moment and the market is buoyant.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation you would be 'most likely to make.
(0/1 Points)

O A. Send an email to your team letting them know about the new targets for Q4.

O B. Call an immediate team meeting to let the team know about the new targets and say that people are welcome to come to you if they need further information or support.

O C. Allow the team to enjoy their Christmas holidays, congratulate them on a job well done this quarter and wait until January to tell them about the target hike.

D. Meet individually with all your advisors as soon as possible and explain the challenge

O to them. Ask for their thoughts and input on how they might go about meeting the v/ targets and addressing the offshore bonds push.

1 5. It is late January and the team have been working towards an increased target for nearly a month. You have reviewed their performance informally just to keep tabs on progress and it appears that most of the advisors are hitting the new targets even with the 20% hike, although the likelihood of them significantly exceeding the offshore bonds target is low.

However, you have spotted that one of the team, Rick Essien, is falling behind and has not even equalled his third quarter performance (based on a like-for-like comparison). You haven't seen Rick for a few days as he has been travelling to meet clients elsewhere in Nigeria but when you last saw him, he looked rather harassed and tired. Another of the advisors mentioned in passing that Rick had talked about suffering from terrible insomnia at the moment and not being able to do anything about it. Rick is due in the office today; you have checked his calendar and he only has one client appointment this afternoon. It appears he is free this morning.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation you would be most likely to make.
(1/1 Points)

A. When Rick arrives take him for a coffee and say that you know he has got bad

O insomnia at the moment and that you feel sorry for him. Remind him of the bank's employee health insurance.

B. When Rick arrives, arrange a one-to-one chat for some time this morning. During the

O meeting, state the issue that exists with his performance currently. Ask him what his v/ views are on how to tackle the underperformance. Offer help if appropriate.

C. As soon as Rick gets into the office, call him aside. Ask him why he has such an empty

O calendar today when he is not meeting his targets and should be doing everything he can to 'up his game'.

O D. Take Rick to lunch before his afternoon meeting and have a general chat about how things are going and how he is feeling.

16. You have just received an email from Mr. G. Balewa. He is one of your team's most important and high-value clients. Currently the advisor assigned to Mr. Balewa is Rick Essien, who is falling behind his targets.

In the email, Mr. Balewa sets out three issues about which he is dissatisfied. Firstly, and most importantly, he asked Rick to make a large stocks and shares investment for him three weeks ago, and he has just found out that Rick only got around to making the investment yesterday. Secondly, Rick has missed two appointments with Mr. Balewa in the last month although they have been in regular contact on the telephone and by email. And finally, Mr. Balewa feels that

Rick, on occasion, is presenting a bad image for New Money Bank as he sometimes arrives at appointments wearing jeans and an open-necked shirt.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation you would be most likely to make.
(1/1 Points)

O A. Immediately call Mr. Balewa and apologise. State that you will be talking to Rick very shortly to ensure that none of these issues ever arise again.

O B. Send an acknowledgement email to Mr. Balewa. Contact Rick as soon as he is next available and inform him of the problem; ask for the background to the issues. Call Mr. Balewa and apologise and inform him of how Rick and you plan to ensure these issues will not arise again. ✓

O C. Send an apologetic email to Mr. Balewa and assure him these issues will not arise again.

O D. Immediately inform Rick and Mr. Balewa that you are switching Mr. Balewa's account to another advisor.

17. It is April. You have just returned from an unscheduled seminar called by the Head of Private Banking at which an invited speaker explained there is to be an emergency change in the regulation of offshore bonds effective immediately.

The context is that there has been reported mis-selling of these bonds as they are a tax- efficient way of investing money but that SEC rules on the amount of value that one individual is allowed to hold in these bonds has been flouted on numerous occasions by unscrupulous traders and financial advisors. Therefore, from today, the purchase of these bonds will involve a 3-month lead-in period, whereby the bonds are held in a Government trust account whilst the purchase is investigated and approved by SEC.

The invited speaker at the seminar has stated that he believes that this will effectively "kill the market" in these bonds. There will still be demand from longterm, low-risk investors but the more short-term, growth-orientated investors will lose interest. Your team has particularly high targets for these bonds for the first quarter of this year as they had been selling incredibly well.

Therefore, you now are facing three months of failure to meet this target as a team.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation you would be most likely to make.
(0/1 Points)

C) A. Email your advisors and inform them of the new regulations, include a link to the regulator's website to give them the full details of the changes.

B. Call a team meeting urgently and ask the team for ideas and input with regard to the

O issue of selling these bonds now. Ask for details of clients who are currently showing interest in these investments and brainstorm how to keep them interested.

O C. Watch the financial news channels to see if there is more analysis and information that you can gather during the course of the day on this key regulatory change.

D. Speak to the Head of Private Banking and ask whether there is any chance that the

O first quarter targets can be amended or revised to take into account this new development.

Scenario 5

You are a Team Manager working for Pfizer Pharmaceuticals in their Nigerian headquarters in Lagos. Pfizer is a global company that develops, manufactures and markets medical drugs in 60 countries worldwide. You manage a team which is responsible for the research, support and marketing of

Mathadone which is a drug that combats high levels of bad cholesterol.

Your team consists of 1 5 research & development scientists and technicians and 4 marketing professionals. You also have 20 global account managers who support the sales of Mathadone in all of Pfizer's worldwide markets.

18. You have just briefed the team on a new market launch for Mathadone which will involve two of your global account managers and your R&D group. Pfizer want to start selling Mathadone in Ghana and the Togo in 6 months' time.

The Ghanaian food and drug regulations are different and more stringent than many other countries in the region and part of the team's job will be to demonstrate empirically (through recorded lab work) that the drug meets these safety standards. Following your briefing one of the R&D team, Bisi Harrington, approached you to say that she believes the launch deadline is unrealistic. She thinks this because in order for the research to count towards market approval, it must be published in a peer-reviewed journal and it can take up to 4 months to have a report approved for such a journal.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate whether you believe the response to be Very Effective.
(0/1 Points)

A. Ask the R&D Team and the relevant account managers to outline a draft project plan based on realistic deadlines, by the end of the day.

O B. Call the Head of Marketing Central & Eastern Europe and tell her that the deadline is not achievable.

C. Outline a draft of a project plan for the Russia and Ukraine launch. Incorporate Bill's comments about it taking up to 4 months to publish in a peer reviewed journal.

O D. Tell Bill that the deadline has been set by the senior management and by the CEE Marketing experts and therefore it must be realistic.

O E. Spend a day with the launch sub-team going through all the elements of the project and drawing up a realistic and detailed draft project plan. ✓

19. You have arrived for work on a Monday morning to the news that the Pfizer Board of Directors have just announced there will be redundancies made in the Nigeria Office this quarter and that this could affect up to 20% of staff.

The announcement has been made on the Pfizers internal staff website. There is no indication of who is under threat from redundancy in the information given, however it has clearly put all your staff on edge, and no-one is in the mood to get on with their work this morning.
Review the following responses A to E and indicate whether you believe the response to be Very Effective.
(0/1 Points)

A. See if you can find out any more information from your line manager and the HQ Human Resources team. Inform your staff that you are seeking clarification and let them know what you find out, if anything.

O B. Buy coffee and doughnuts for the whole team from Swindon's top patisserie to cheer them all up.

C. Tell the team that there is no point in getting stressed as they probably won't be in

O the firing line and they should get on with their work to take their minds off the situation

D. Call a brief team meeting to get the staff questions and concerns on the situation.

O Take their questions and put them to the Human Resources team. Inform the staff as to ✓ whether you receive any clarification or not.

E. Scrutinise the internal website and HR bulletins to see if you can find any extra information to enlighten or reassure your staff.

20. You received an email from Bisi Harrington which she has labelled urgent and confidential. In it she tells you that she has just finished analysing a batch of tests for a routine review of Mathadone's 'unintended outcomes'; sometimes called the 'side effects' of the drug. She says that she was stunned to find that there was a slight drop in the blood sodium levels of the rats she had been studying. The danger is that if Mathadone really does have an impact on users' sodium levels then there is a risk of people developing hyponatremia which causes the kidneys to have to work very hard to maintain the right levels of sodium in the body. One of the extreme outcomes of hyponatremia can be the sufferer going into a coma.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate whether you believe the response to be Very Effective.
(0/1 Points)

A. Ask Bill to replicate the study and ask one of Bill's colleagues to verify the results.

B. Call the manufacturing plant in Poland immediately and tell them to halt production

O until a change can be made to the 'possible side effects' information given with the drug.

O C. Call a contact of yours at Science Today magazine and ask whether he knows of any recent media coverage of hyponatremia.

O D. Take Bill's data to your boss and alert her that there may be an issue here.

O E. Bring in an independent laboratory to verify (or disprove) Bill's results. v/

21. One of the key ingredients in the outer coating of the capsule form of Mathadone is magnesium stearate (MS); it is made from hydrogenated palm oil. Due to the worldwide outcry against oil palm plantations (which have been found to be responsible for a large amount of deforestation in the tropics which leads to the displacement of wildlife and the warming of the Earth's climate) the production of palm oil has fallen drastically and the price risen. Therefore, the cost of magnesium stearate has risen as well.

You have been asked to attend an emergency meeting to discuss the implications for the cost of Mathadone manufacture; colleagues from Finance, HQ Marketing and Manufacturing (Europe) are also attending the meeting.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate whether you believe the response to be Very Effective.
(1/1 Points)

A. Ask your team to attend the meeting with you to present information to the attendees about what the function of MS is in the design of the Mathadone capsule.

B. Research the cost of MS as a percentage of the entire cost of a single unit of

O Mathadone; run a projection to show how an increase in the cost of MS affects the cost of mathadone production.

C. Search the internet for low-cost sources of MS; compare prices between
O manufacturers.

O D. Attend the meeting and ask your colleagues how you might be best able to help them.

O E. Ask your team for a full report on how MS is used in the Mathadone capsule which they initially designed; ask for a list of valid alternative ingredients, if possible. ✓

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